

Caro-Kann Advance Repertoire

Space, the active ...Bf5 bishop, kingside expansion, and Black's c5 and e6 breaks



Use the Advance Variation to gain space while learning how to challenge Black's active bishop without overextending.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use the Advance Variation to gain space while learning how to challenge Black's active bishop without overextending.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
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WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Unlike the French, Black usually develops the c8 bishop before ...e6.

PRINCIPLE 2

Nc3 and g4 gain time but increase tactical responsibility.

PRINCIPLE 3

The h-pawn can trap or chase the bishop only when the center is stable.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Black's ...c5 attacks d4 and ...f6 attacks e5.

PRINCIPLE 5

A space advantage needs development behind it.

PRINCIPLE 6

The Panov and Classical lines are useful alternative structures.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Advance Caro core | Challenge ...Bf5 only while the center prevents counterplay. |
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| 02 | Advance with h5 | When ...h5 stops h5, compare g5 with development. |
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| 03 | Short system | Nf3 and Be2 trade some space-gaining tempo for safer development. |
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| 04 | Advance ...c5 | Black's immediate ...c5 attacks d4 before developing the bishop. |
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| 05 | Advance ...b5 | Against ...b5, ask whether ...b4 is a concrete threat. |
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| 06 | Gurgenidze setup | A Caro fianchetto attacks d4 and dark squares rather than developing Bf5. |
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| 07 | Classical alternative | The Classical line exchanges the e-pawn but gives White easy development. |
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| 08 | Panov alternative | The Panov trades structure for activity and familiar IQP play. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Advance Caro core



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nc3 e6 5. g4 Bg6 6. h4 h6

WHITE'S IDEA

Gain time against the bishop and use space for a kingside initiative.

MAIN DANGER

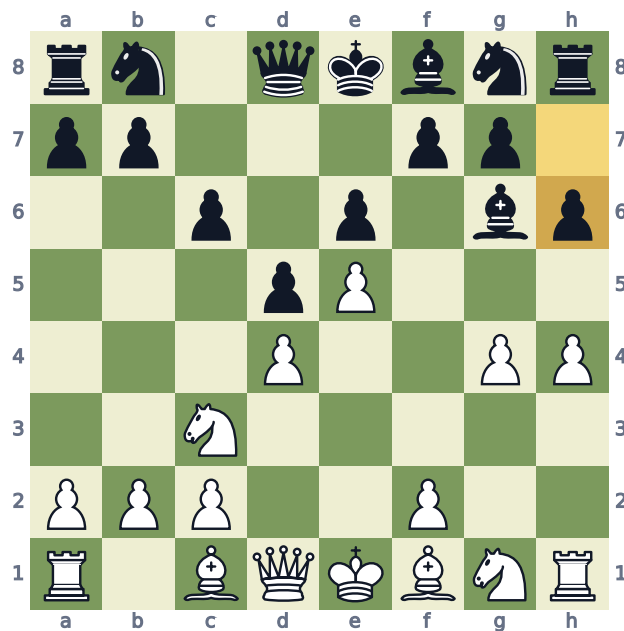
Pawn pushes weaken the king and can overextend.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Challenge ...Bf5 only while the center prevents counterplay.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.62 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 Bh7 2. Nf3 c5 3. Be3 c4 4. Bh3 Qb6 5. Rb1 Bb4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Advance Caro core



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Advance with h5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nc3 e6 5. g4 Bg6 6. h4 h5

WHITE'S IDEA

Fix the kingside and decide whether g5 gains space or closes useful lines.

MAIN DANGER

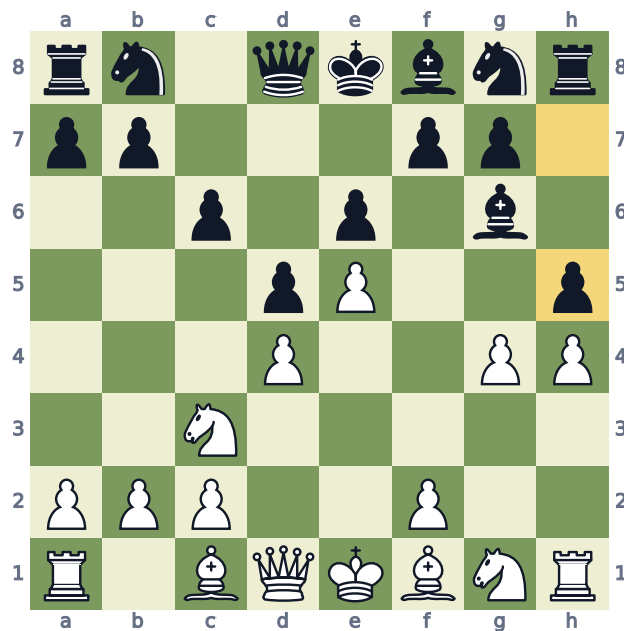
Closing with g5 can give Black f5 and e4 squares.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When ...h5 stops h5, compare g5 with development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.69 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg5 Be7 2. Bxe7 Nxe7 3. gxh5 Bxh5 4. Be2 Bxe2 5. Ncxe2 Nf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Advance with h5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Short system



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nf3 e6 5. Be2 c5 6. O-O Nc6

WHITE'S IDEA

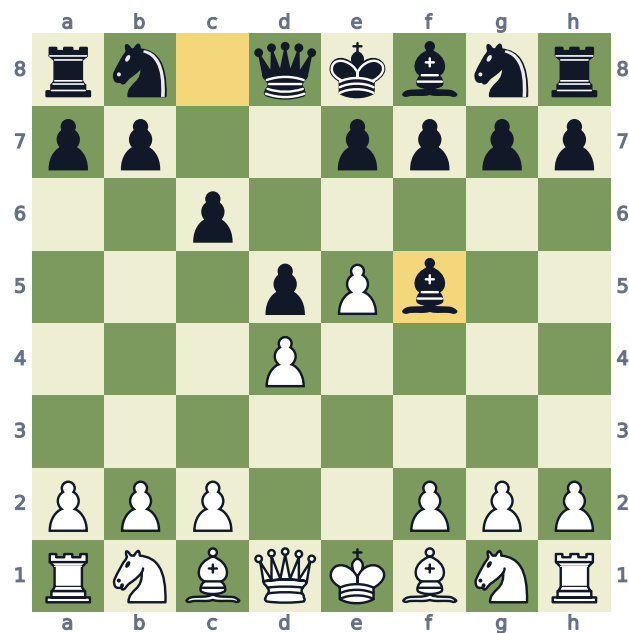
Develop rapidly and maintain the space advantage without early pawn weaknesses.

MAIN DANGER

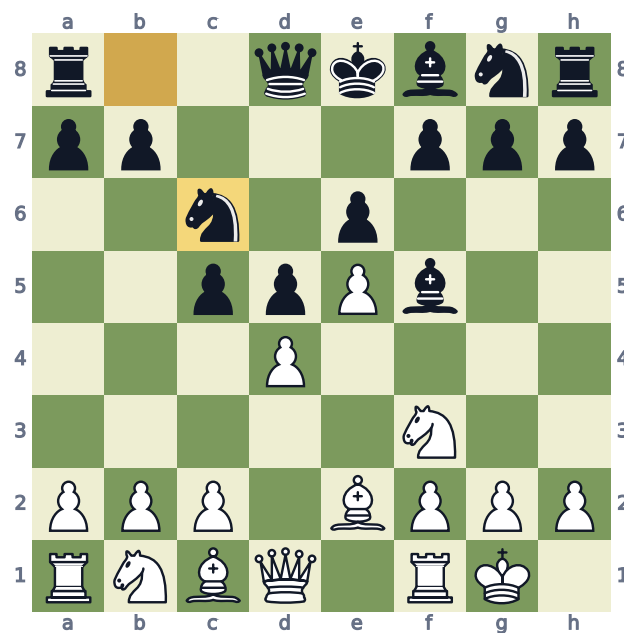
Black may equalize with ...c5 if White has no active plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Nf3 and Be2 trade some space-gaining tempo for safer development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.27 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c3 cxd4 2. cxd4 Bg4 3. Nc3 Ng7 4. h3 Bxf3 5. Bxf3 Nf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Short system



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Advance ...c5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. dxc5 e6 5. Be3 Nd7

WHITE'S IDEA

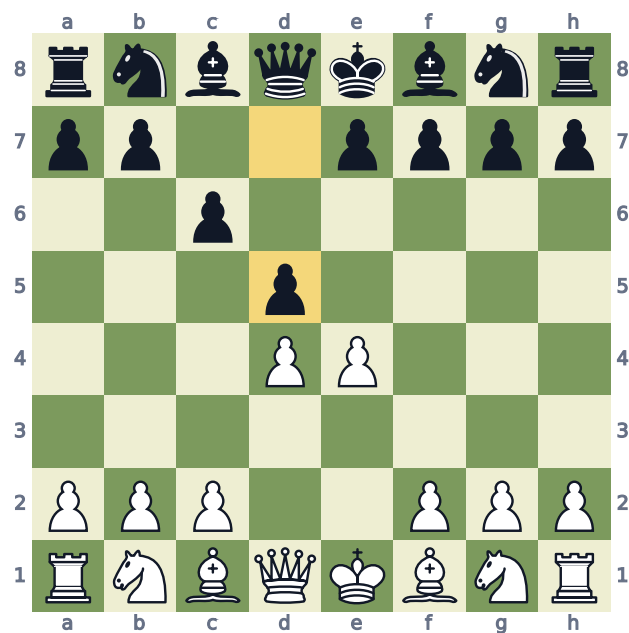
Accept the pawn temporarily while supporting e5 and developing.

MAIN DANGER

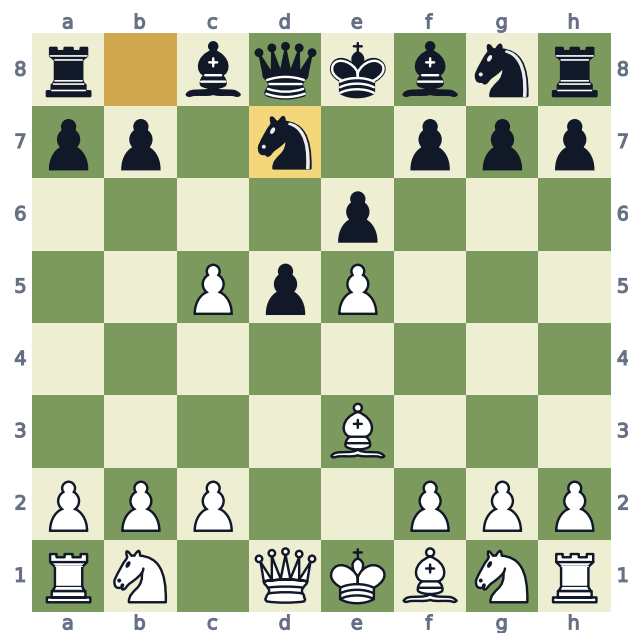
Holding c5 can cost time and allow ...Nxc5.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Black's immediate ...c5 attacks d4 before developing the bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

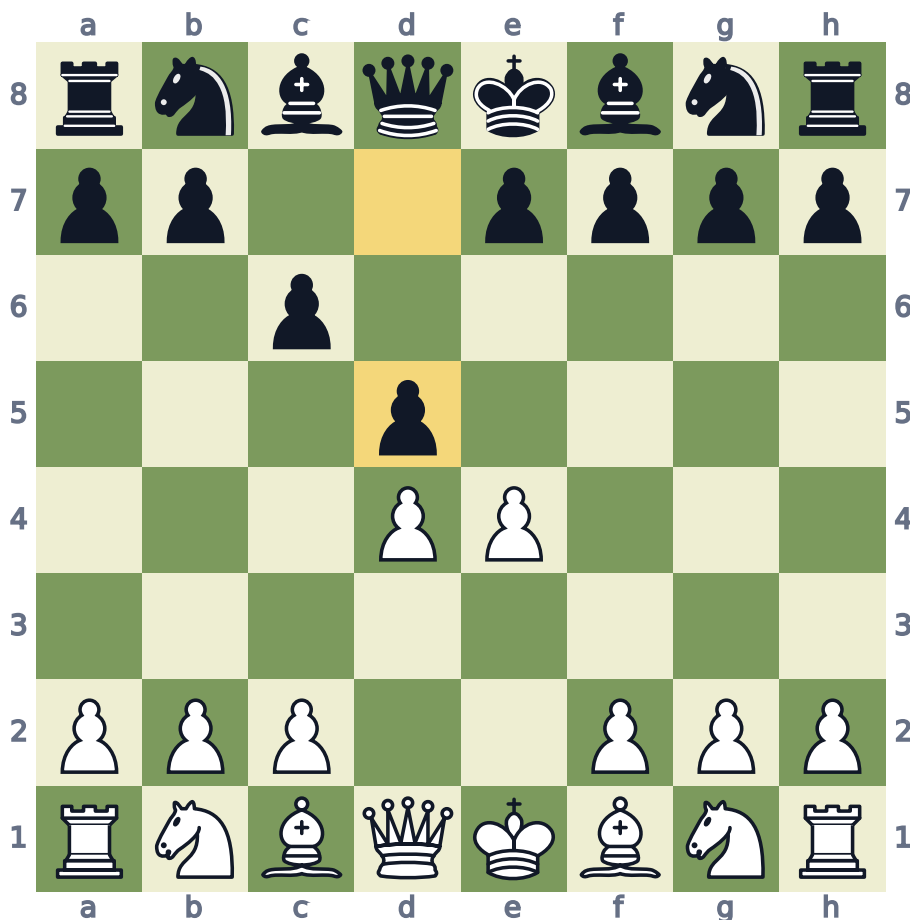
Position estimate: +0.34 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb5 a6 2. Bxd7+ Bxd7 3. Nf3 Ne7 4. c3 Nf5 5. Bd4 Nxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Advance ...c5



YOUR TASK

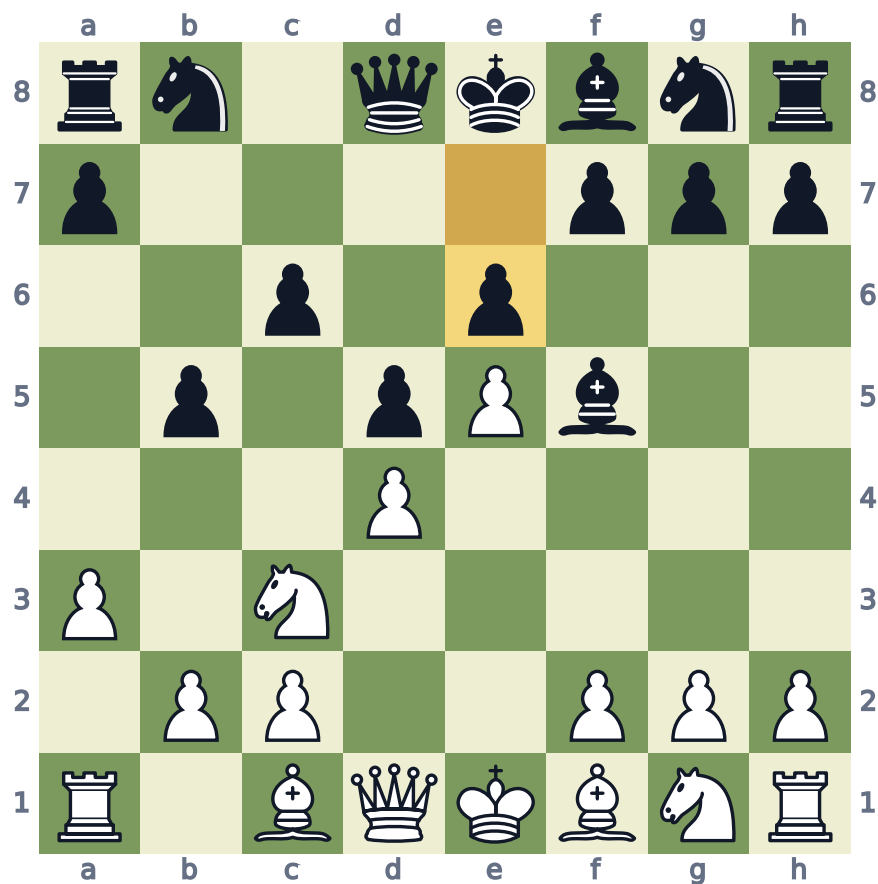
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Advance ...b5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nc3 b5 5. a3 e6

WHITE'S IDEA

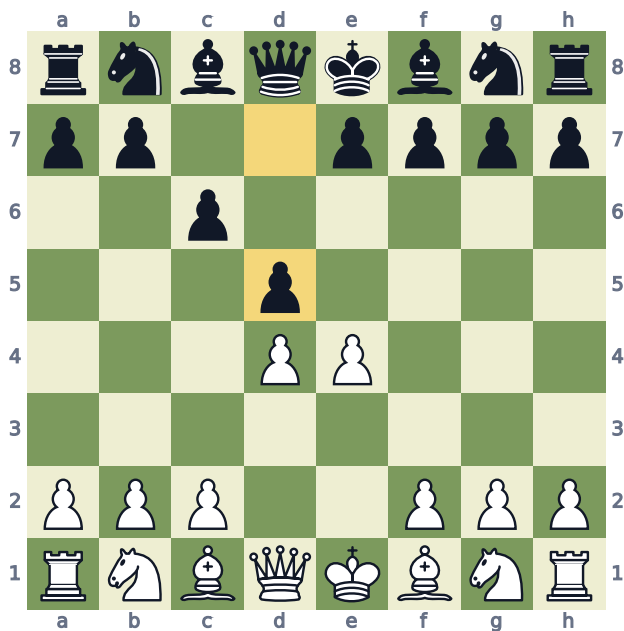
Prevent ...b4 from dislodging the c3 knight and continue development.

MAIN DANGER

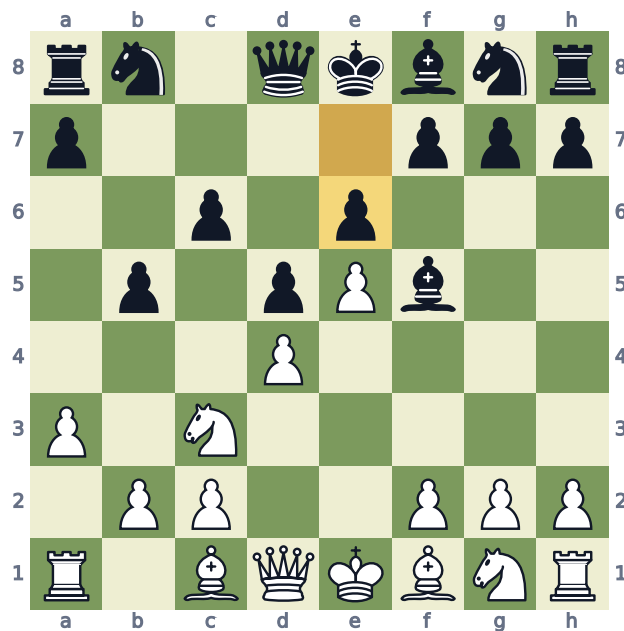
a3 spends time and creates b3 weakness if no expansion exists.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...b5, ask whether ...b4 is a concrete threat.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.03 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. g4 Bg6 2. Nge2 Ne7 3. Ng3 h6 4. h4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Advance ...b5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Gurgenidze setup



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 g6 4. Nc3 Bg7 5. f4 h5

WHITE'S IDEA

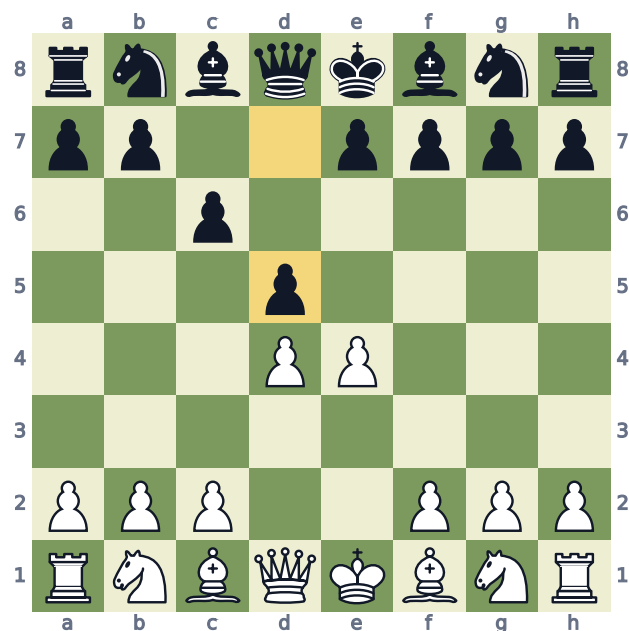
Build space and prevent Black from undermining e5 without preparation.

MAIN DANGER

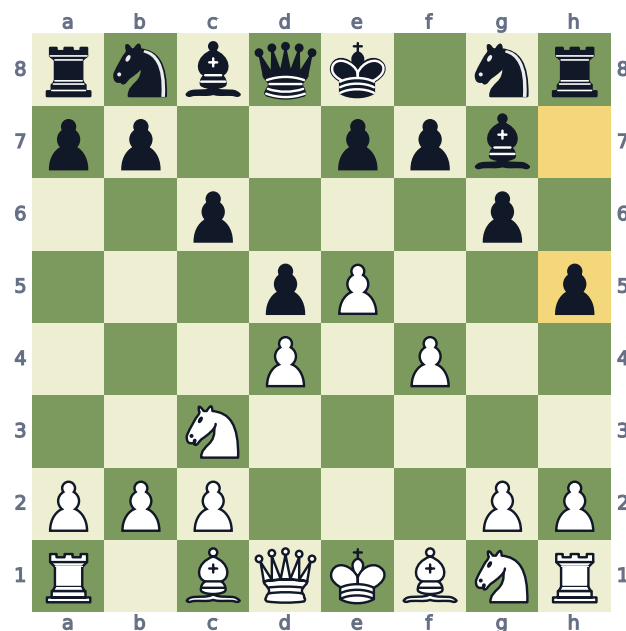
f4 and h-pawn play can expose the king.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A Caro fianchetto attacks d4 and dark squares rather than developing Bf5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

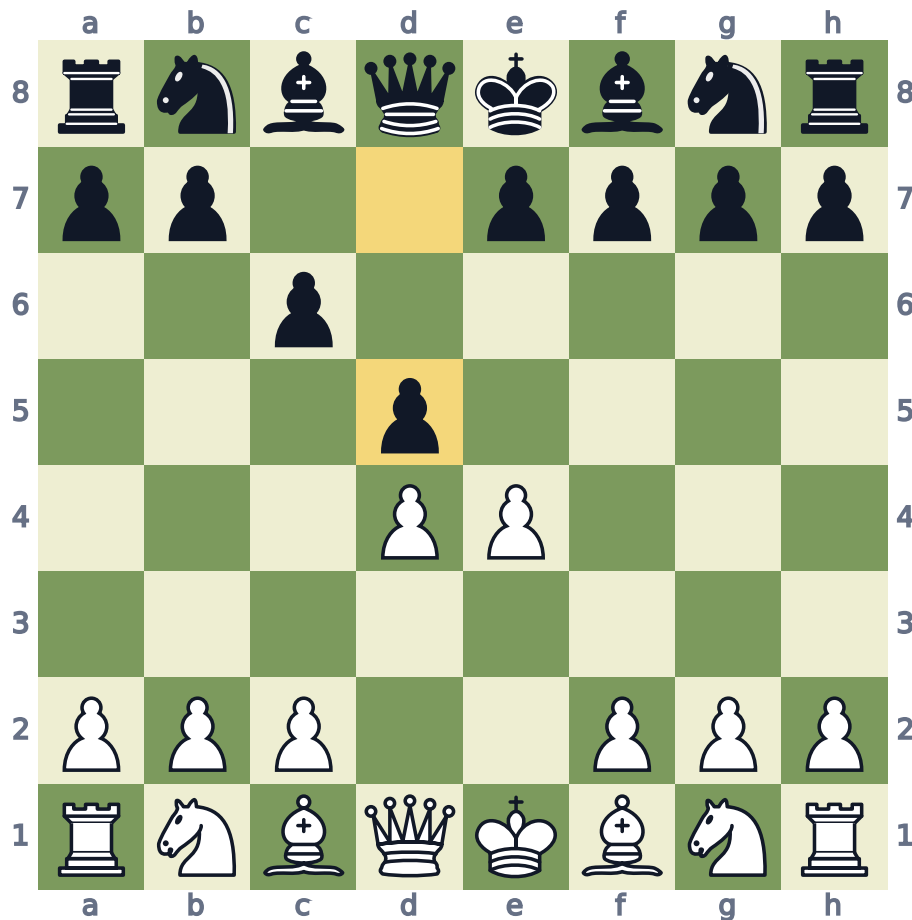
Position estimate: +0.76 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h3 Nh6 2. Be3 Bf5 3. Bf2 Nd7 4. Nf3 e6 5. Qd2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Gurgenidze setup



YOUR TASK

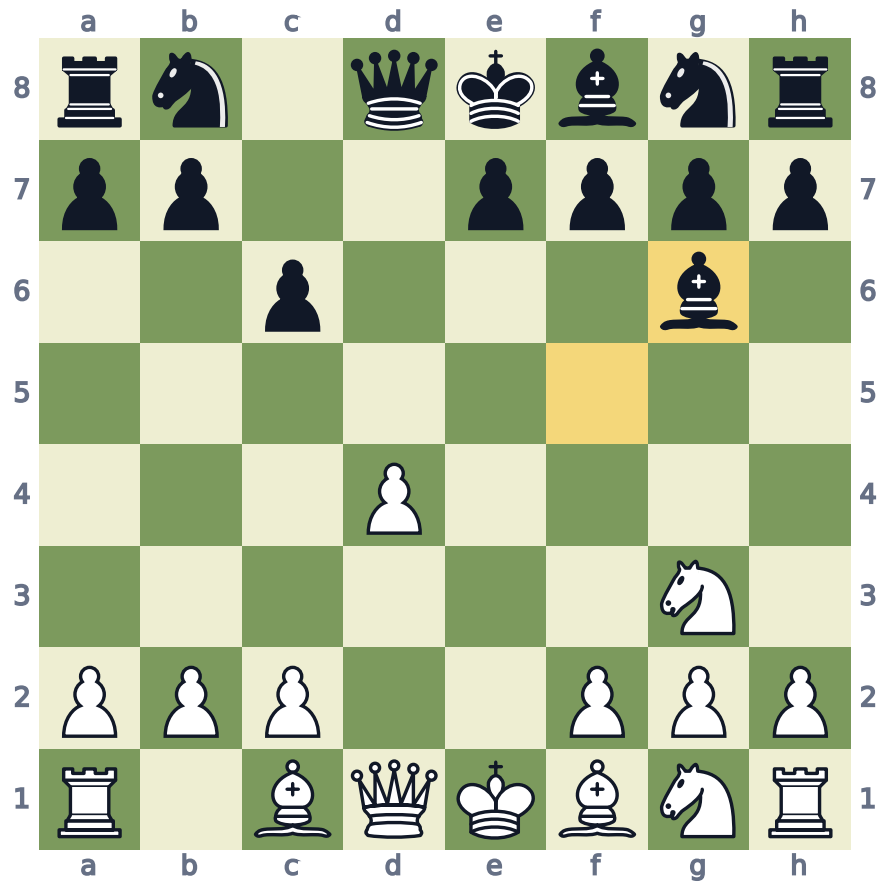
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Classical alternative



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nc3 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6

WHITE'S IDEA

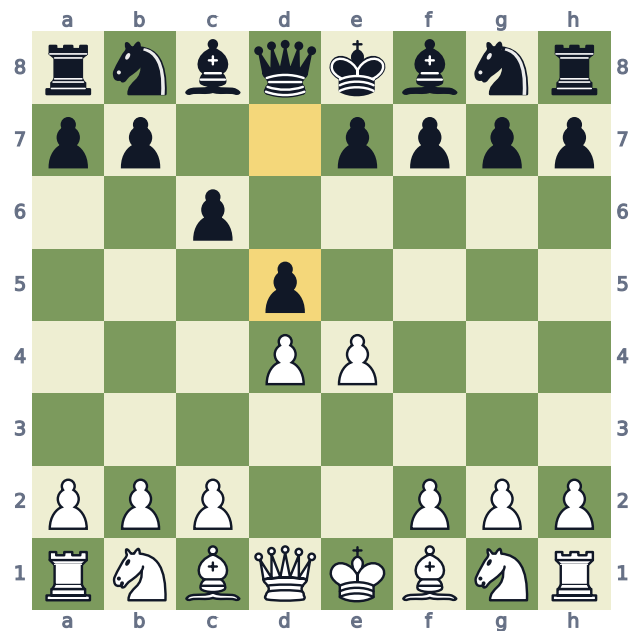
Develop naturally and use the active knight against Black's bishop.

MAIN DANGER

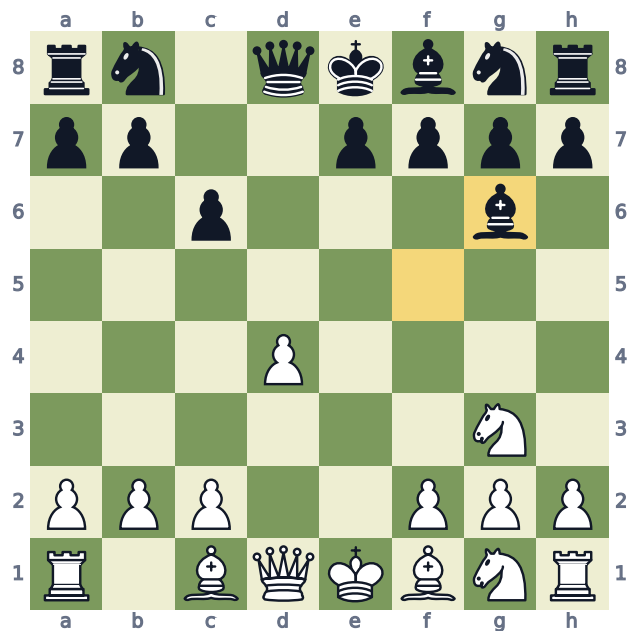
The knight can be chased by ...Nf6 and ...e6.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The Classical line exchanges the e-pawn but gives White easy development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

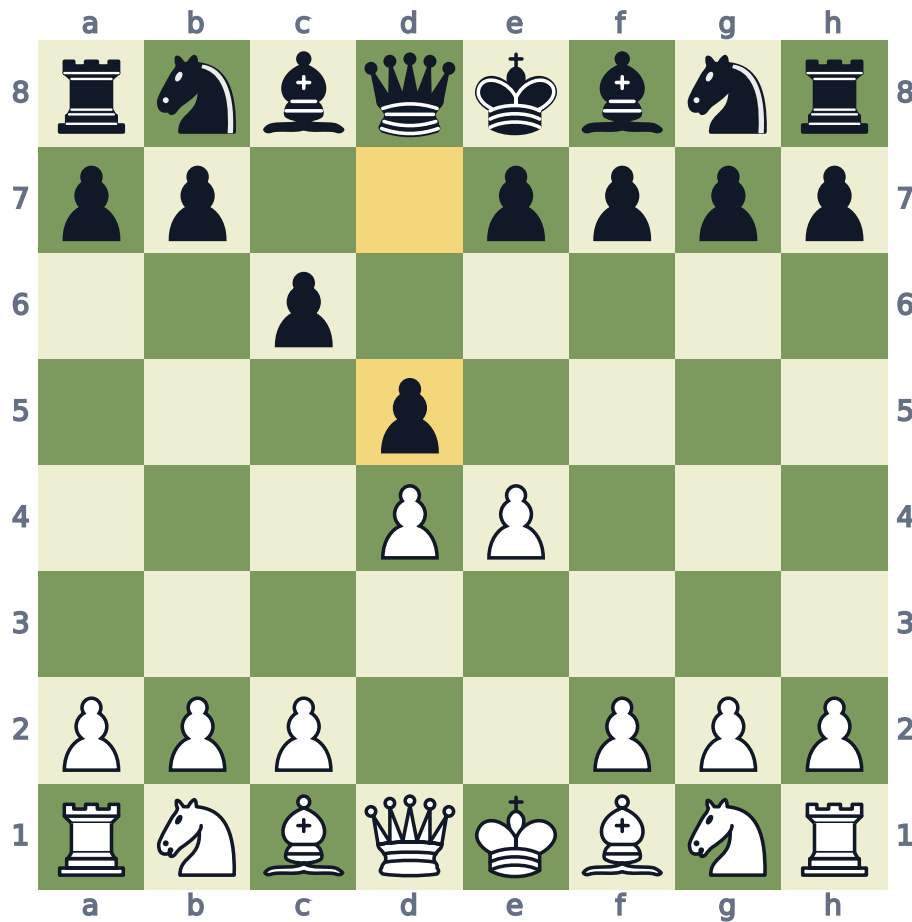
Position estimate: +0.31 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf3 Nd7 2. Bd3 e6 3. O-O Qc7 4. Re1 Be7 5. c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Classical alternative



YOUR TASK

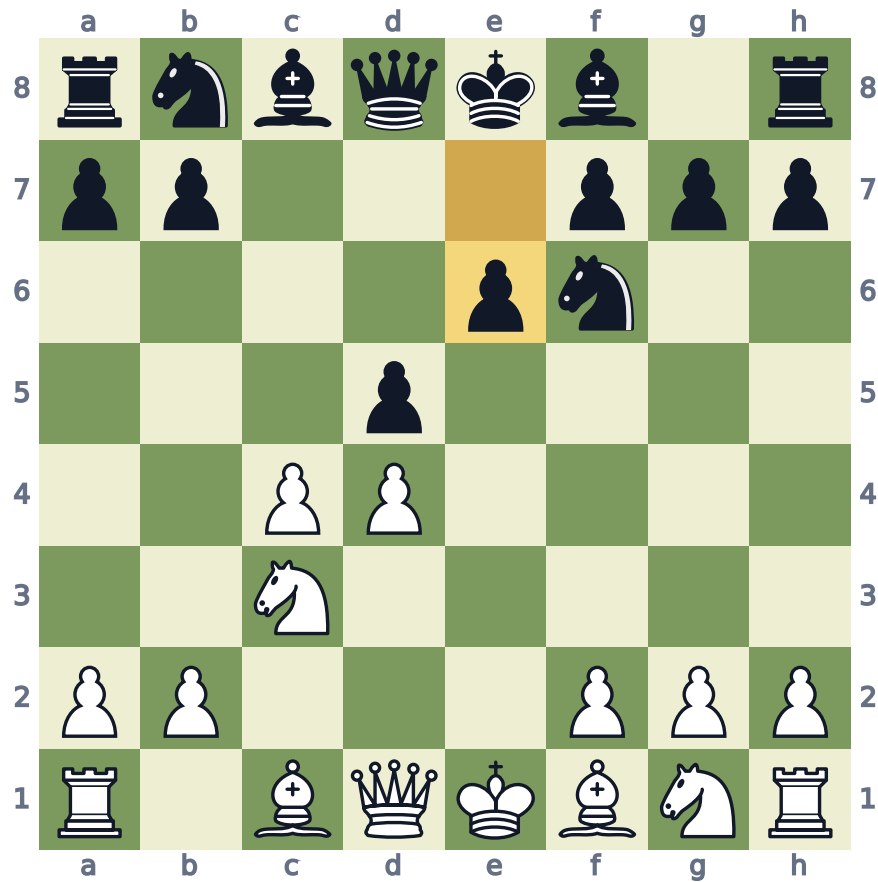
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Panov alternative



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. exd5 cxd5 4. c4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6

WHITE'S IDEA

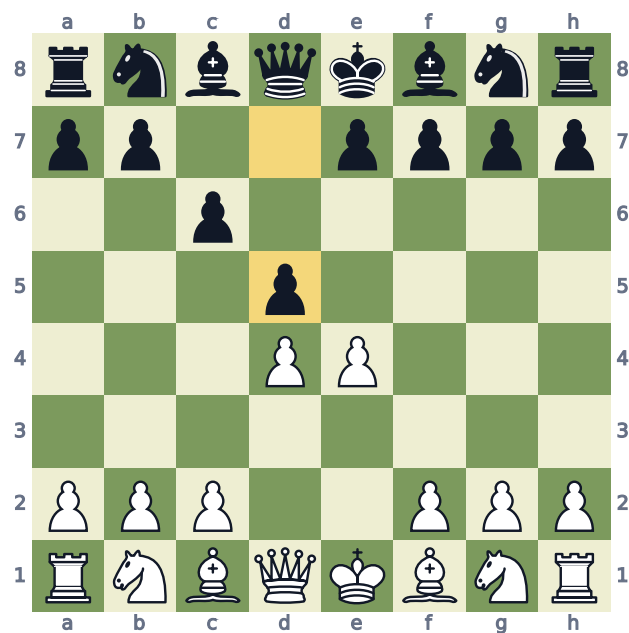
Create an isolated-queen-pawn structure with active pieces and open files.

MAIN DANGER

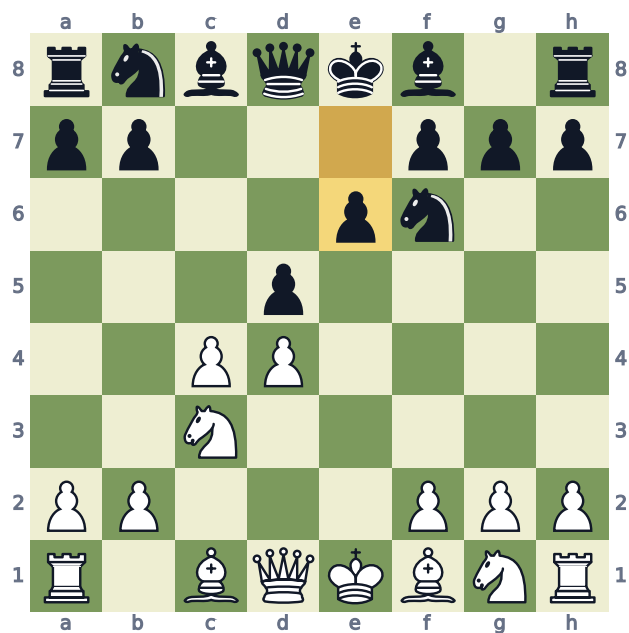
The d4 pawn can become a long-term target after exchanges.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The Panov trades structure for activity and familiar IQP play.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

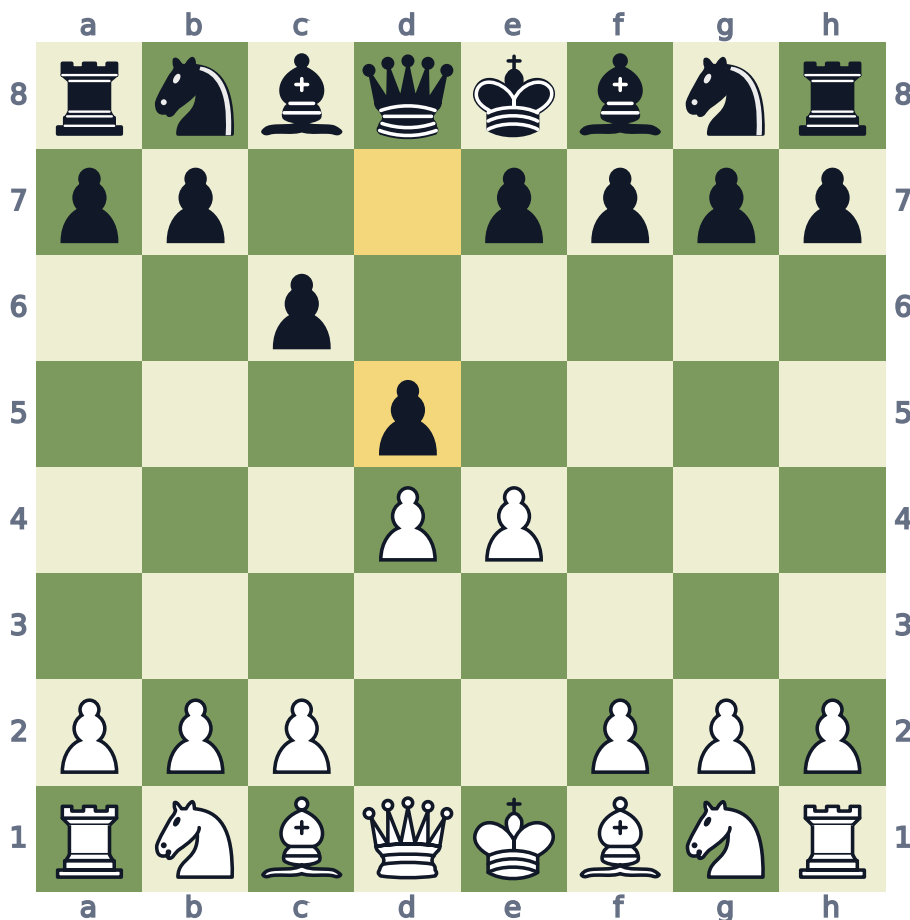
Position estimate: +0.30 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf3 Bb4 2. Be2 O-O 3. O-O dxc4 4. Bxc4 b6 5. Re1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Panov alternative



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. ADVANCE CARO CORE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Gain time against the bishop and use space for a kingside initiative. Engine comparison: 1. g4 Be4 2. f3 Bg6 3. h4 h5 4. Ne2 e6 5. Nf4 hxg4 (+0.40 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Pawn pushes weaken the king and can overextend.

02. ADVANCE WITH H5

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Fix the kingside and decide whether g5 gains space or closes useful lines. Engine comparison: 1. g4 Be4 2. f3 Bg6 3. h4 h5 4. Ne2 e6 5. Nf4 hxg4 (+0.40 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Closing with g5 can give Black f5 and e4 squares.

03. SHORT SYSTEM

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Develop rapidly and maintain the space advantage without early pawn weaknesses. Engine comparison: 1. g4 Be4 2. f3 Bg6 3. h4 h5 4. Ne2 e6 5. Nf4 hxg4 (+0.40 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may equalize with ...c5 if White has no active plan.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. ADVANCE ...C5

Course move: e5. Purpose: Accept the pawn temporarily while supporting e5 and developing. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Bf5 2. g4 Bd7 3. Be3 e6 4. Nf3 c5 5. dxc5 Qa5+ (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Holding c5 can cost time and allow ...Nxc5.

05. ADVANCE ...B5

Course move: e5. Purpose: Prevent ...b4 from dislodging the c3 knight and continue development. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Bf5 2. g4 Bd7 3. Be3 e6 4. Nf3 c5 5. dxc5 Qa5+ (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: a3 spends time and creates b3 weakness if no expansion exists.

06. GURGENIDZE SETUP

Course move: e5. Purpose: Build space and prevent Black from undermining e5 without preparation. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Bf5 2. g4 Bd7 3. Be3 e6 4. Nf3 c5 5. dxc5 Qa5+ (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: f4 and h-pawn play can expose the king.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. CLASSICAL ALTERNATIVE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Develop naturally and use the active knight against Black's bishop. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Bf5 2. g4 Bd7 3. Be3 e6 4. Nf3 c5 5. dxc5 Qa5+ (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The knight can be chased by ...Nf6 and ...e6.

08. PANOVA ALTERNATIVE

Course move: exd5. Purpose: Create an isolated-queen-pawn structure with active pieces and open files. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Bf5 2. g4 Bd7 3. Be3 e6 4. Nf3 c5 5. dxc5 Qa5+ (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The d4 pawn can become a long-term target after exchanges.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.